

Extension contao-pdfforms-bundle (EN)

This Contao extension from Softleister extends the form generator with the option of filling out, saving and sending a PDF template with the data entered in the online form.

The **contao-pdfforms-bundle** extension is installed as a limited demo. The demo version prints a demo note in the PDF with full functionality and is limited to 2 output pages. The full functionality is activated with a licence key. The licence allows you to use the extension in the domain specified at the time of purchase. Use in other domains requires an additional licence.

Contao versions 5.3 and 5.7 require different releases of the extension:

- Contao 5.3 ... 5.6: contao-pdfforms-bundle ^2.3
- Contao 5.7 ... : contao-pdfforms-bundle ^2.4

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1. System Requirements

The extension in version **2.4** is approved for **Contao 5 from version 5.7** onwards:

For **Contao 5 with versions 5.3 ... 5.6**, please use version **2.3**.

The Composer or the Contao Manager is required for the installation.

2. Interaction with other extensions

With the following extensions further features are available:

notification_center (terminal42/notification_center)

contao-pdfforms-bundle sends via the normal "Contao Form Generator Submissions". The generated file can be attached to the mail using a token.

mp_forms (terminal42/contao-mp_forms)

Starting with pdf_forms version 2.1, **multi-page forms** structured with mp_forms are also supported.

Note: mp_forms is not yet available for Contao 5.7, so it could not be tested.

fineuploader (terminal42/contao-fineuploader)

Starting with pdf_forms version 2.2, uploads can also be used via the Fine Uploader. The form fields are then named fileuploader_0...x (where fineuploader is the assigned field name).

Note: mp_forms is not yet available for Contao 5.7, so it could not be tested.

3. Installation

Simply install the extension with the **Contao Manager**, search for

PDF form output oder **do-while/contao-pdfforms-bundle**

or on the command line with the **Composer**:

```
composer require do-while/contao-pdfforms-bundle
```

For Contao 5.3 ... 5.6, you must set the version to ^2.3 in the Contao Manager!

You can first install the extension as a demo and check its suitability for your project. The demo has all the features, but is limited to 2 output pages. Before you go online, you will need your licence code:

www.softleister.de/kontakt/anfrage.html?erw=pdfforms

Enter the licence code in the .env.local file in the base directory of the Contao installation. This is described in more detail in your licence document, which you will receive after purchasing the licence.

Multi-form template

Condition

Pages from the PDF template

⋮

tarif~A

▼

1-3,7

📄

🗑️

⋮

tarif~B

▼

4-6,7

📄

🗑️

If the condition is fulfilled, only the specified pages are used

Specify a list of the corresponding pages separated by commas or as range

If the template file contains different forms, applicable pages can be defined here, e.g. 1-4,7,10. Leave the fields blank to use all pages.

☒ **Take all valid document pages**
 Applies also template pages without position entries in the PDF.

Basic offset

0

-4.8

X and Y displacement in millimeters of all positions on the sides.

text color in PDF

2012a3

■

Please select the pen color to fill in the entries

Title

Real estate expert opinion

Title of PDF document

Author

mycompany.tld

Stated author in the PDF properties

In the example, there is a radio button element where you can select tariff A or B. Depending on the selection in the form, only the specified pages are output, so pages 1, 2, 3 and 7 are output for tariff A, and pages 4, 5, 6 and 7 for tariff B (the page numbers always refer to the template). Further conditions can also be used to control attachments.

If you leave the Multiple templates element completely empty, the complete template PDF will be used.

Use **Take all valid document pages** to control whether all template pages should be transferred to the PDF or only the pages on which valid items are entered. This allows you to create optional pages using the template. If a single blank page (e.g. terms and conditions) is nevertheless included, enter a position that prints a blank. For multiple templates, "All pages" only refers to the pages of the template released via the conditions.

When you measure the form and enter the positions, there are often differences to the paper margin. This shift then applies to all items in the PDF. To avoid having to adjust every position, you can simply equalise the **basic offset** by making an entry in the form properties.

For the display, you can enter the **text colour in the PDF** and the **title** and **author** for the file properties.

The text colour can be overwritten individually in the individual items, e.g. to set off a heading in colour.

It is possible to protect the generated PDF with a password. There are 2 ways:

☒ **Protect PDF**
The PDF is provided with password protection

PDF password for permissions

If this field is left blank, a random password is generated

PDF password for opening

Leave the field blank if open without a password should be possible.

Permissions

- ☐ *Select all*
- ☐ Print
- ☒ Print in high resolution
- ☐ Modify the document
- ☐ Insert pages, rotate, delete, bookmarks
- ☐ Remove pages
- ☒ Copying content
- ☐ comment on
- ☐ Fill in form fields

Select everything that should be possible without a password.

a) Restriction of authorisations, enter all released authorisations here. If the PDF password for authorisations is left blank, a random password is generated. The password is then unknown.

b) Password protection when opening the document You can enter a password here to prevent unauthorised opening of the PDF. For security reasons, send the password in a separate email or via SMS or a suitable messenger.

Note: The PDF protection is not completely secure. With appropriate programs, the password can be bypassed!

Use your own fonts:

Custom font (regular)

Change selection

Select your font file for the regular font or leave the field empty for the

Custom font (bold)

Change selection

Select your font file for the bold font or leave the field empty for the

Custom font (italic)

Change selection

Select your font file for the italic font or leave the field empty for the

Custom font (bold+italic)

Change selection

Select your font file for the bold italic font or leave the field empty for the

TTF or OTF fonts can be assigned for each of the 4 possible font styles (regular, bold, italic, bold+italic) in the PDF positions. Where no font is selected, the default font remains.

It is also possible to assign different fonts to font styles. For example, a decorative font for special effects can be assigned to the bold+italic font style to highlight special entries.

5. Definition of positions in the PDF

There is an additional icon (a PDF symbol) in the overview of the created forms. The positions of the entries in the template PDF are defined in the following table. Any number of items can be created.

[↩ Go back](#)
[➕ New position](#)
[📄 Download Test PDF](#)
[✎ Edit multiple](#)
[🔍 Filter](#)

It is possible to generate a completed **Test PDF** directly in the backend. This allows you to quickly check whether all items are filled in correctly in the form. All published items are output, and the field name is displayed for form fields.

Since no input data is available, the conditions are not checked, meaning that all fields and all pages are transferred to the test PDF.

v Type of position
Type of position

Text position v

 Select the type of position

There are different types of positions:

- **Text position** - Output of form content, texts and insert tags
- **Picture position** - Output of image data
- **Barcode** - Output of a barcode from form content, text, InsertTags

Creating the individual items:

a) Text positions

Fill PDF form

Inputs and texts

Field name or "text"	Condition	
lastname	-	used
","	firstname	used
firstname	-	used

Enter the field name, or a text in The text is output only when the field is filled, in Inversion: used = selected/checked; empty =
 Input values and/or text to be inserted her into PDF

Overwrite text color

000ac0

☐ No automatic spaces

Suppresses the automatic insertion of spaces between fields.

Leave the field blank if you do not want to overwrite the default text color

Remarks and notes

complete name

These notes are not displayed in the frontend

The information to be entered is set in the first section. The following options are available:

- a field name from the form
- a fixed text in quotation marks
- InsertTags must also be enclosed in quotation marks, as they are to be processed as text

In the example, these are the form fields lastname and firstname and a fixed text with a comma. These individual definition lines are strung together with spaces (no space before a comma). If the **automatic space** character is annoying in rare situations, you can switch it off.

A condition can be programmed for the output in the 2nd column. If the condition is empty, the position is always output. In the example, the comma depends on whether the **firstname** field in the form has been filled in (used). The comma is therefore only output if the firstname has been filled in.

The condition can also be inverted:

used = field filled in / checkbox or radio button selected

empty = field is empty / checkbox or radio button not selected

The fixed texts can also contain insert tags:

▼ Fill PDF form

Inputs and texts

Field name or "text"	Condition	
city	city	used
,"	city	used
"{{date::d.m.Y}}"	-	used

Enter the field name, or a text in The text is output only when the field is filled, in Inversion: used = selected/checked; empty =
Input values and/or text to be inserted her into PDF

In this example, "Berlin, 2018-02-04" or only "2018-02-04" entered in the PDF, depending on whether city is specified or not.

To cross check boxes, we use an "X" with the checkbox value in the condition:

Inputs and texts

Field name or "text"	Condition	
"X"	terms_conditions_accepted~1	used

Enter the field name, or a text in The text is output only when the field is filled, in selections the Inversion: used = selected/checked; empty =
Input values and/or text to be inserted her into PDF

In the **Remarks and notes** line, you can save notes on the position, for example for checkboxes or radio buttons where only an "X" is displayed, the option can be described here for the backend view.

If you want to display all selected values as text in a comma-separated list, simply enter the field name.

In the lower part of the backend form it comes to the position in the PDF where the selected information is entered and the font attributes.

A good way to determine the positions is to measure the PDF page in programs such as Photoshop. The offset can be quickly determined in a position test and included in the other positions.

Note: The positions always refer to the basic offset in the form properties

If a position specification begins with + or -, then the position is placed **relative** to the previous position. For example, the Y position "+5" can be used to set the output to 5 mm below the last output position.

There are 4 options for integrating images into the PDF:

- Select an image from the file manager
- Take an image from the upload, i.e. from the form
- An image that is contained in the form data as a DataStream (e.g. from the signature extension [do-while/contao-signature-formfield-bundle](#))
- Include an image via the UUID of the file (e.g., 735e095f-a30e-11ee-9009d02fd8b3)
- Include an image using the file path (e.g., files/contademo/media/demo-images/contao-on-blue.jpg)

▼ Positions and attributes

Page in PDF*

1

Page on which the item is to be inserted

Condition

-

The item is only output if the condition is fulfilled or the condition is empty.

Position in X and Y*

25

100

Position in mm from the upper left corner. If the value begins with + or -, the position is relative to the page width and height.

Dimensions*

50

50

Size of the box width x height in mm. If one value is specified as 0, it will be the same as the other.

The page, position and size are specified for all image positions. The image is always cropped to the specified dimensions (MODE_CROP = Exact format). It is also possible to specify a condition for inclusion, the image is then only included if the condition is met. For example, images can be integrated to match a selection field.

Image selection Image source File Use an image from file or from a data stream. Picture*  Change selection Select your picture	Image selection Image source Upload file Use an image from file or from a data stream. Image data* stdupload Define the form field that contains the image data or a UUID.
Image selection Image source Data stream Use an image from file or from a data stream. Image data* signature Define the form field that contains the image data or a UUID.	Image selection Image source UUID or file path Use an image from file or from a data stream. Image data* files/contao-demo/media/demo-images/contao-on-blue.jpg Specify the form field that contains the image data, a UUID, or a path in the

Contao 5.7: It is now possible to upload multiple files using the file upload feature. To address a specific file, `_0`, `_1`, etc. is appended to the field name. Example: if the field name is `stdupload` and 3 files are uploaded, the files can be accessed under the field names `stdupload_0`, `stdupload_1`, and `stdupload 2`.

c) Barcode

Include a barcode from your data in the PDF:

Type of position

Type of position
Bar code
Select the type of position

Barcode type
QR-CODE - Better error correction
Select a barcode type

Fill PDF form

Inputs and texts

Field name or "text"	Condition	
"{{custom::partnumber}}" Enter the field name, or a text in Input values and/or text to be inserted her into PDF	- The text is output only when the field is filled, in	used Inversion: used = selected/checked; empty =

Overwrite text color
111666

☐ No automatic spaces
Suppresses the automatic insertion of spaces between fields.

Remarks and notes
Part number from insert tag
These notes are not displayed in the frontend

The following barcode types are available:
(dependent on the type, the character set is partially restricted)

2D bar codes

- QR-Code - Low error correction
- QR-Code - Medium error correction
- QR-Code - Better error correction
- QR-Code - Best error correction
- PDF417 (ISO/IEC 15438:2006)
- Datamatrix (ISO/IEC 16022:2006)

1D bar codes

- Code 39 - ANSI MH10.8M-1983 - USD-3 - 3 of 9
- Code 39 + Checksum
- Code 39 Extended
- Code 39 Extended + Checksum
- Code 93 - USS-93
- Standard 2 of 5
- Standard 2 of 5 + Checksum
- Interleaved 2 of 5
- Interleaved 2 of 5 + Checksum
- Code 128 AUTO

- Code 128 A
- Code 128 B
- Code 128 C
- EAN 8
- EAN 13
- UPC-A
- UPC-E
- 5-Ziffern UPC-Based Extension
- 2-Ziffern UPC-Based Extension
- MSI
- MSI + Checksum (module 11)
- Codabar
- Code 11
- Pharmacode
- Pharmacode TWO-TRACKS
- IMB - Intelligent Mail Barcode - Onecode – USPS-B-3200
- Postnet
- Planet
- RMS4CC (Royal Mail 4-state Customer Code) - CBC (Customer Bar Code)
- KIX (Klant index - Customer index)

▼ Positions and attributes

Page in PDF*

1

Page on which the item is to be inserted

Condition

-

The item is only output if the condition is fulfilled or the condition is empty.

Position in X and Y*

25

100

Position in mm from the upper left corner. If the value begins with + or -, the position is relative to the edge of the page.

Size of bar code

3

Select the size.

6. Setting up the email attachment

In the form properties, there is an option in the further processing selection called "Save PDF file and attach it to the email." If this further processing option is selected, the generated file will be sent as an attachment with the email.

When using the **Notification Center**, there is a SimpleToken for the „Attachments via tokens" field in the notification. Enter the token **##form_pdfattachment##** there to attach the generated PDF file.

7. Directory protection, protected PDF

To prevent direct downloads of PDF files, which often contain personal data, the template and storage directory can be protected in the file manager. The files can still be used as email attachments without restriction.

In addition, the created PDF can be protected with a password. The protection can prevent opening or restrict authorisations.

Note: The PDF protection is not completely secure. With appropriate programs, the password can be bypassed!

8. Insert tags

The extension replaces insert tags in the position definitions, so that, if necessary, dynamic data or the data of the registered member may be used.

The extension also provides its own insert tags available:

```
{{pdf_forms::pdfdocument}}
```

can be used to include the file link of the generated document in a download link. If you are not using the Contao download content element, the file must be publicly accessible; in the case of a protected PDF directory, the download must take place via the Contao content element.

```
{{pdf_forms::pdfdocument::name}}
```

can be used to insert only the file name of the generated document in the reply page. This is also the file name of the PDF attachment to the email.

```
{{pdf_forms::password_random}}
```

generates a random password, e.g. as the permissions password for the PDF.

```
{{pdf_forms::form_*}}
```

With this InsertTag, it is possible to add transferred content from a form field to the PDF file name in the form properties. For example, a process number from a hidden table field.

Replace the * with the name of the form field.

9. For programmers and developers

This section is aimed at programmers who want to influence this extension in their own modules.

Internal field variables for PDF

New in version 2.3 are internal field variables that can be entered via the `pdf_formsBeforePdf` hook. These variables can then be used in exactly the same way as form fields from the submitted form. To be able to use these variables in the conditions, an entry must be made in `config/config.yaml` so that these fields are added to the conditions SELECT:

```
# config/config.yaml

softleister_pdfforms:
  add_condition_options: [foo, bar]
```

In the example, the field variables **foo** and **bar** are made available for conditions. After entering them in the `config.yaml` file, the Symfony cache must be cleared/refreshed.

The variables and their values are then created in the `pdf_formsBeforePdf` hook (see below).

Hooks

In the program flow, you can link in at various points using a HOOK registration. The extension **contao-pdfforms-bundle** calls the registered hooks, if any are registered.

The following hooks are available:

pdf_formsBeforePdf

Is called after data preparation **before** the PDF is created. Here, further entries can be added to the `$arrPDF` array or existing entries can be modified. The hook must return the `$arrPDF` as the return value.

Example:

```
// src/EventListener/Pdf_formsBeforePdfListener.php
<?php

namespace App\EventListener;

use Contao\CoreBundle\DependencyInjection\Attribute\AsHook;

#[AsHook('pdf_formsBeforePdf')]
class Pdf_formsBeforePdfListener
{
    public function __invoke(array $arrPDF)
    {
        // any code

        // Example: Adding internal field variables
        //          The variables can be used in the PDF in the same way
        //          as form data. To use the field in conditions, an entry
        //          in config/config.yaml is necessary (see above).

        $arrPDF['arrFields']['foo'] = ['type'=>'text', 'value'=>1, 'orig'=>'foo',
'options'=>''];
        $arrPDF['arrFields']['bar'] = ['type'=>'text', 'value'=>'', 'orig'=>'bar',
'options'=>''];

        // Example: The text output of the upload field with the field name
        //          'singleupload' should enter the file name and 1 last
        //          directory before it in the PDF. The default is only the
        //          file name without the directory.
        //
        //          Option: basename: Number of directories before

        if( isset( $arrPDF['arrFields']['singleupload'] ) ) {
            $arrPDF['arrFields']['singleupload']['options'] = 'basename:1';
        }

        return $arrPDF;
    }
}
```

```
}
```

pdf_formsPositions

Is called up for **each item** in the form during PDF creation. It is still possible to manipulate data here. The page number cannot be changed, otherwise the output will not work correctly. The passed and possibly modified array \$arrItem is expected as the return value.

Example:

```
// src/EventListener/Pdf_formsPositionsListener.php
<?php

namespace App\EventListener;

use Contao\CoreBundle\DependencyInjection\Attribute\AsHook;

#[AsHook('pdf_formsPositions')]
class Pdf_formsPositionsListener
{
    public function __invoke(array $arrItem, array $arrPDF)
    {
        // any code

        return $arrItem;
    }
}
```

pdf_formsAfterPdf

Is called up **after** creation, saving and transfer to form processing. Further final activities can be inserted here using a hook. The hook has no return value.

Example:

```
// src/EventListener/Pdf_formsAfterPdfListener.php
<?php

namespace App\EventListener;
```

```
use Contao\CoreBundle\DependencyInjection\Attribute\AsHook;

#[AsHook('pdf_formsAfterPdf')]
class Pdf_formsAfterPdfListener
{
    public function __invoke(string $pdfdatei, array $arrPDF): void
    {
        // any code
    }
}
```

10. Troubleshooting

Collection of some points which could cause errors:

The template PDF file can not be read

The template PDF must be readable for the extension `tcpdf_ext`, it must be available in the PDF specification format 1.4 (Acrobat 5.x). Recent PDF versions must be converted to the older format before.

In Adobe Acrobat on "Save As ..." select "Adobe PDF files optimized (*.pdf)" and then adjust the settings to "Acrobat 5.0 and higher."

The text does not have the right position in the form PDF generator

The measured positions usually have a fixed offset, which comes from the over- and under-lengths in the font. The easiest way is to set a text on test position and measure the difference to the desired position. This basic offset can be entered in the form properties and will calculate in the output at each position.

There are fields that do not exist in PDF form, but should be output in the document anyway.

Simply enter an additional page number, if the target page is not included in the template, a blank page is added where additional information can be placed in the same way.